

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Four-lens decision architecture

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Four-lens decision architecture

[1] State the dilemma and identify the genuinely competing values.

|
v

[2] Kant test one: formulate and universalise the proposed maxim.

|
v

[3] Kant test two: ensure every affected person is treated as an end.

|
v

[4] Mill test one: compare benefits, harms, probability, duration and distribution.

|
v

[5] Mill test two: ask whether coercion prevents harm or merely enforces preference.

|
v

[6] Aristotle test: identify the virtues, extremes and context-sensitive proportion.

|
v

[7] Rawls test: examine the underlying rule from the least-advantaged position.

|
v

[8] Map convergence and justify a transparent tie-break where theories diverge.

|
v

VERDICT -> No single lens is automatically decisive; name convergence and defend the tie-break.

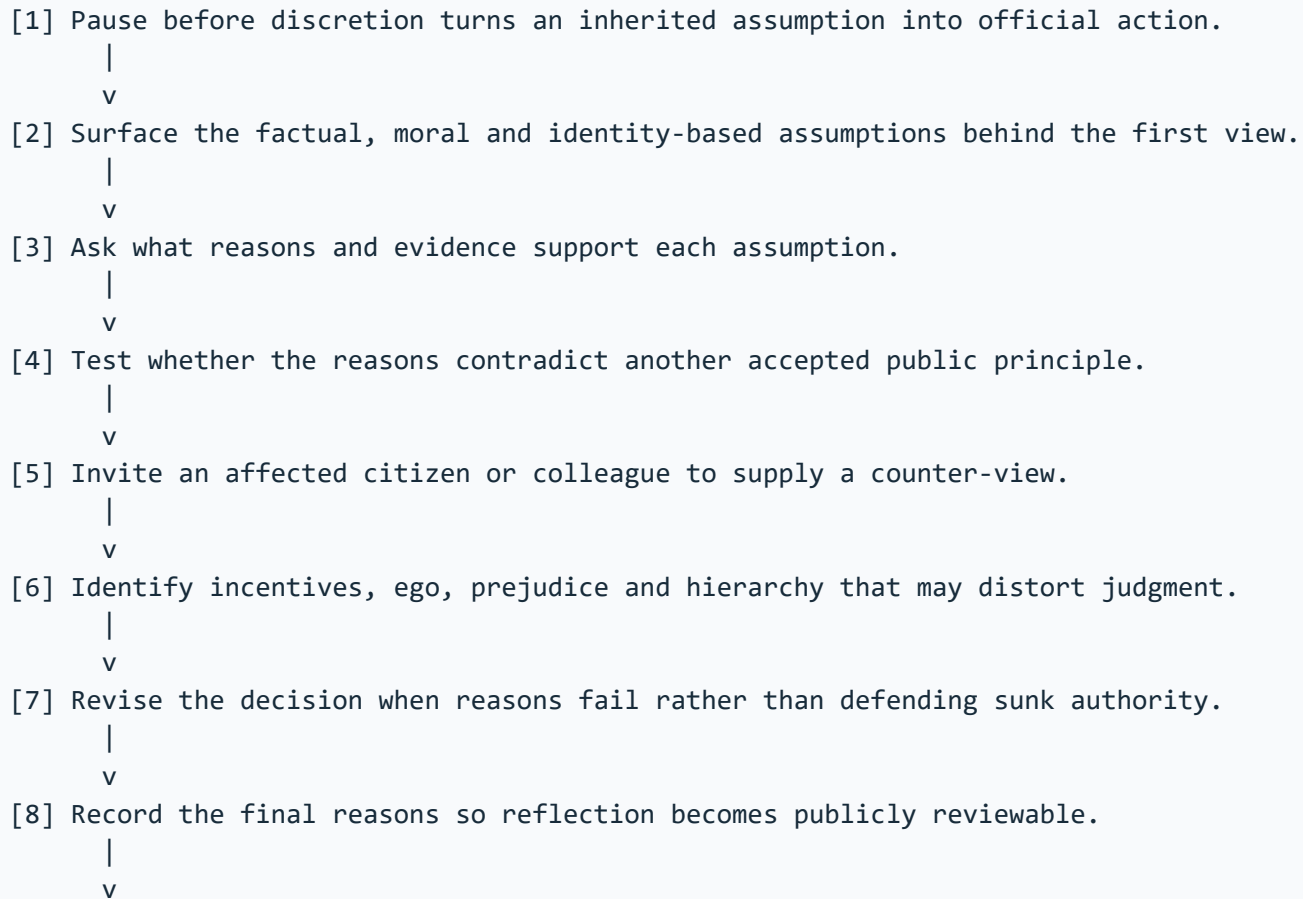
ANSWER USE -> Use as the opening framework for multi-value dilemmas and Section B case studies.

MUST REMEMBER: Western thinkers require accurate arguments, not quotation lists: Socratic...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. Socratic examination loop

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2. Socratic examination loop



VERDICT -> Socratic reflection becomes administrative ethics only when it produces revisable reasons.

ANSWER USE -> Use for bias, conscience, discretion, consultation and ethical-leadership answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Plato's soul-city harmony

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3. Plato's soul-city harmony

- [1] Reason identifies the good and should govern the individual.
|
v
- [2] Spirit supplies courage and disciplined support to rational judgment.
|
v
- [3] Appetite supplies necessary desire but must not capture decision-making.
|
v
- [4] Inner justice exists when the three parts perform ordered functions.
|
v
- [5] Rulers deliberate for the common good rather than private appetite.
|
v
- [6] Auxiliaries protect the polity under rational and lawful direction.
|
v
- [7] Producers sustain material life without usurping every public function.
|
v
- [8] Modern use requires participation, rights and checks against elite domination.
|
v

VERDICT -> Plato supplies an order-and-competence analogy, not a licence for unaccountable technocracy.

ANSWER USE -> Use for Plato, institutional role clarity, self-mastery and merit-with-accountability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Aristotle's virtue and proportionality map

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4. Aristotle's virtue and proportionality map

[1] Human telos directs ethics toward eudaimonia or whole-life flourishing.

|
v

[2] Virtue is a stable disposition, not a single conspicuous good act.

|
v

[3] Habituation forms reliable courage, justice, temperance and generosity.

|
v

[4] Deficiency marks one vice, such as cowardice or negligent inaction.

|
v

[5] Excess marks the opposite vice, such as rashness or punitive over-reaction.

|
v

[6] The mean is relative to circumstances, never a fixed numerical midpoint.

|
v

[7] Phronesis identifies the fitting action through trained practical judgment.

|
v

[8] Law, evidence and review prevent practical wisdom becoming arbitrary discretion.

|
v

VERDICT -> The virtuous mean is reasoned proportion bounded by law, not compromise at any cost.

ANSWER USE -> Use for proportionality, crowd control, crisis judgment and virtue-ethics questions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. Kantian Categorical Imperative decision test

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5. Kantian Categorical Imperative decision test

[1] State the maxim describing what the official proposes and why.

|
v

[2] Imagine the maxim operating as a universal rule for all officials.

|
v

[3] Test contradiction in conception: would universal practice destroy the institution?

|
v

[4] Test contradiction in will: could a rational person accept that universal world?

|
v

[5] Apply the humanity formula to every affected person's agency and dignity.

|
v

[6] Reject manipulation, coercion or concealment that uses persons merely as means.

|
v

[7] Distinguish acting from duty from strategic outward conformity.

|
v

[8] Choose the duty-consistent option and state consequences only as implementation factors.

|
v

VERDICT -> Favourable consequences cannot cure an impermissible maxim or instrumental treatment.

ANSWER USE -> Use for honesty, confidentiality, consent, corruption and rights-based dilemmas.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Kant 2024 quotation provenance ladder

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6. Kant 2024 quotation provenance ladder

- [1] UPSC 2024 Q3(c) prints the law-versus-ethics guilt formulation.
 - |
 - v
- [2] The wording is absent from Kant's published Groundwork and mature ethical treatises.
 - |
 - v
- [3] Louis Infield's 1930 Lectures on Ethics contains the closely matching passage.
 - |
 - v
- [4] The passage appears under 'Innocence' on printed pages 212-13.
 - |
 - v
- [5] The German reconstruction used Brauer's student notebook as its principal base.
 - |
 - v
- [6] Kutzner and Mrongovius notebooks were used for collation and correction.
 - |
 - v
- [7] UPSC modernises 'harboured the thought' into 'only thinks of doing so.'
 - |
 - v
- [8] Answer the proposition while identifying it as a student-note-based adapted passage.
 - |
 - v

VERDICT -> The idea is substantively Kantian, but the printed UPSC sentence is textually adapted.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the provenance box and opening qualification for the 2024 PYQ.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Utilitarian policy calculus

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7. Utilitarian policy calculus

- [1] Identify every affected group, including diffuse and politically weak interests.
|
v
- [2] List direct, indirect and opportunity benefits rather than one headline output.
|
v
- [3] List physical, economic, dignity, ecological and institutional harms.
|
v
- [4] Estimate probability and uncertainty instead of treating projections as certainties.
|
v
- [5] Separate immediate effects from cumulative and intergenerational consequences.
|
v
- [6] Test distribution because aggregate gain may conceal concentrated severe loss.
|
v
- [7] Evaluate both the particular act and the consequences of its general rule.
|
v
- [8] Apply rights and harm safeguards before declaring the largest total decisive.
|
v

VERDICT -> Aggregation is informative only when uncertainty, distribution and liberty are visible.

ANSWER USE -> Use for cost-benefit policy, triage, infrastructure and resource-allocation answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Mill's harm-principle gate

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8. Mill's harm-principle gate

[1] Confirm whether the person is a competent adult exercising meaningful agency.

|
v

[2] Ask whether the conduct is substantially self-regarding.

|
v

[3] Identify concrete other-regarding effects rather than vague social dislike.

|
v

[4] Separate demonstrable harm from offence, immorality claims and paternalism.

|
v

[5] Place the evidentiary burden for coercion on the public authority.

|
v

[6] Select the least restrictive effective measure where harm is established.

|
v

[7] Protect minority individuality against majoritarian social pressure.

|
v

[8] Review spillovers and evidence because the boundary of harm can change.

|
v

VERDICT -> Liberty is presumed; coercion requires demonstrable harm and proportionate means.

ANSWER USE -> Use for speech, lifestyle, surveillance, public health and paternalism questions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Rawlsian lexical-priority staircase

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9. Rawlsian lexical-priority staircase

[1] Begin with persons as free and equal moral agents.

|
v

[2] Secure a fully adequate equal scheme of basic liberties.

|
v

[3] Refuse to trade those liberties for income or administrative efficiency.

|
v

[4] Next secure fair equality of opportunity for offices and prospects.

|
v

[5] Test substantive access, not merely formal absence of discrimination.

|
v

[6] Give fair opportunity priority over the difference principle.

|
v

[7] Permit inequality only when it benefits the least advantaged.

|
v

[8] Treat efficiency as a separate feasibility consideration constrained by justice.

|
v

VERDICT -> The lexical order is liberty, fair opportunity, then the difference principle.

ANSWER USE -> Use to prevent the most common Rawls sequencing error in welfare answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Veil-of-ignorance policy test

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10. Veil-of-ignorance policy test

-
- ```
graph TD; A[1] --> B[2]; B --> C[3]; C --> D[4]; D --> E[5]; E --> F[6]; F --> G[7]; G --> H[8];
```
- [1] Define the rule affecting society's basic institutions and opportunities.  
|  
v
  - [2] Bracket knowledge of the designer's class, identity, talent and eventual position.  
|  
v
  - [3] Identify the primary goods distributed by the proposed rule.  
|  
v
  - [4] Reason from the possibility of occupying any affected social position.  
|  
v
  - [5] Test access and burden from the most vulnerable plausible standpoint.  
|  
v
  - [6] Compare feasible alternatives rather than declaring one abstract design perfect.  
|  
v
  - [7] Use reflective equilibrium to revise both principles and considered judgments.  
|  
v
  - [8] Publish the fairness rationale, exclusions, evidence and review mechanism.  
|  
v

VERDICT -> The veil is a fairness heuristic for institutional design, not literal ignorance.

ANSWER USE -> Use for subsidy, reservation-adjacent, health, education and algorithmic eligibility.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Golden Mean is not arithmetic moderation, Kant is not rule worship...

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Displacement-project four-lens comparison

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#### 11. Displacement-project four-lens comparison

[1] State the public benefits claimed for the infrastructure project.

|  
v

[2] Identify concentrated livelihood, cultural and ecological costs to the community.

|  
v

[3] Kant requires dignity, agency, consultation and non-instrumental treatment.

|  
v

[4] Mill compares comprehensive long-term welfare rather than headline monetary output.

|  
v

[5] Mill's harm principle places the burden on coercive displacement.

|  
v

[6] Aristotle tests alternatives, proportion and the administrator's practical wisdom.

|  
v

[7] Rawls asks whether the design genuinely benefits the least advantaged.

|  
v

[8] Reach conditional approval, redesign or rejection with enforceable safeguards.

|  
v

VERDICT -> Aggregate gain cannot substitute for dignity, proportionality and worst-off protection.

ANSWER USE -> Use for dams, mining, border infrastructure and development-versus-rights dilemmas.

EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: State objections and bounded replies:...

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. Provenance-to-AI-governance bridge

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#### 12. Provenance-to-AI-governance bridge

[1] Begin with the exact official paper or government-document wording.

|  
v

[2] Search for a primary text before assigning book, speech or page.

|  
v

[3] Classify the material as direct, adapted, widely attributed or unverified.

|  
v

[4] Answer the ethical proposition without fabricating authority.

|  
v

[5] Map People First to Kant only as an analytical inference.

|  
v

[6] Map Fairness and Equity to Rawls only as an analytical inference.

|  
v

[7] Map safety, proportion and understandability to Mill, Aristotle and Socrates cautiously.

|  
v

[8] End with accountability, human oversight and publicly reviewable reasons.

|  
v

VERDICT -> Source honesty and explicit inference labels make current-affairs application defensible.

ANSWER USE -> Use for quotation answers and the India AI Governance Guidelines current anchor.